

identification news

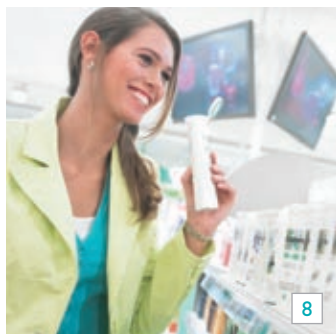
on the move



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PHILIPS

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Editorial

Marc de Jong joined Philips Lighting in 1994, moving up through the organization to become CEO of the European Lamps business in 2003. In November 2005, he took over as General Manager of the Automotive & Identification business unit. In this issue's editorial he looks back at the identification market in 2005 and forward to the challenges of 2006.

Today's markets are highly competitive, and identification is no exception. Even so, 2005 was a particularly challenging year for many players, with constant pressure to deliver maximum cost-effectiveness. To help our customers remain successful, we've been focusing on innovation so we can continue to deliver the right solutions, now and in the future.

Looking ahead, one of the fastest-growing areas in smart cards is eGovernment. Indeed, we expect 2006 to be 'the year of the ePassport', with governments worldwide continuing to roll out projects. Security is obviously vital, and we've worked hard to ensure our SmartMX ICs are certified to the highest security standards. As a result, the vast majority of these ePassport projects will be based on Philips' ICs.

In RFID, smart tags and labels continue gathering momentum in Supply Chain Management applications worldwide, as well as in many other applications. We expect that the EPCglobal's Gen2 standard and its guarantee of interoperability will further accelerate demand. Demand that we're ready for with our UCODE EPC G2 chip, the world's first Gen2-compliant product to be produced in high volumes.

2006 will also be the year when NFC moves from trials into commercial applications. As the only supplier of NFC ICs, we've been working with partners to test ticketing applications in The Netherlands and Germany. In France, we're carrying out the world's first large-scale NFC trial, together with Samsung and France Telecom/Orange. Here, NFC is enabling some impressive services: delivery of digital content and information as well as payment and access applications. And keep your eyes open for a major NFC trial in the US early this year.

These high-profile trials are proving NFC's viability and providing insights into its potential. Simultaneously, the launch of commercially available modules is opening the market to both small and large manufacturers. We believe NFC's ease-of-use will appeal to consumers, and we're here to support customers who want to enter this exciting market early. NFC is a clear proofpoint for Philips commitment to develop and market products that comply with 'Sense and Simplicity'.

Finally, no look ahead could fail to mention Asia Pacific and the continued rapid growth of China and India and economic recovery in Japan. Philips has a long history in these countries and a strong manufacturing and R&D presence throughout APAC. We also have extensive experience in Asia's identification market, particularly public transport ticketing. Our goal is to strengthen our support for customers in this region through tailored products and partnerships.



I truly believe that identification will play an increasingly important role in our lives. Philips remains firmly committed to identification, building partnerships throughout the value chain and providing our customers with market-leading IC solutions.

Marc de Jong

General Manager/CEO BU Automotive & Identification

RFID

where will it go next?



Radio Frequency Identification (RFID) has always been associated with speed and convenience. Quite simply, that's what the technology delivers. But if you associate RFID only with Supply Chain Management (SCM), transport or secure access, it's time to broaden your horizons. Within a few years, RFID will be making our lives simpler and easier in all kinds of ways. For instance, did you know it's already helping take the stress out of medical diagnostics as part of a unique hospital environment developed by Philips?

As a leader in RFID, Philips has long been helping its customers and partners derive business benefits of this versatile technology. Extend these benefits into everyday life and you have a world where people, machines and goods can 'link up'.

A digital camera can show pictures on your TV screen simply by being placed next to it. A fridge knows what's in it and what has to be eaten today or thrown away. A plant pot knows what species is growing in it, and how much light and water it needs.

A trillion tags by 2015

The potential impact of RFID is so vast it is attracting the attention of industry and government worldwide. In October 2005, the Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development (OECD) dedicated a special session to RFID's economic promise and social implications. Delegates from business and research organizations highlighted applications from healthcare to tire pressure monitoring.

Christophe Duverne, Vice President of Philips' Identification business, predicts that RFID will become the prevalent >

'electronic-based intelligence' technology of the 21st century, with a market of a trillion tags by 2015.

This bold vision doesn't ignore the privacy issues that talk of RFID everywhere (sometimes referred to as 'ubiquitous RFID') generates. Concerns over personal privacy, especially in sensitive areas such as healthcare and medicine, must be addressed. We recognize that many consumers want features such as the option to 'kill' RFID tags at the supermarket checkout, so they have control over what information they share with the store, manufacturer or service provider. Indeed, we are actively working with customers, industry partners and governments to create the technological and regulatory structures that will protect confidentiality and individual choice.

Nonetheless, the benefits of RFID are undeniable. It makes life easier – and not just in what might be called 'typical' applications. Philips has recently showcased product concepts that represent an expression of our promise of Sense and Simplicity over the next three to five years. Many incorporate RFID and / or intuitive wireless connectivity.

Next Simplicity

Our 'Next Simplicity' concepts are based on a framework of simplicity-led design. This starts from the perspective of what makes sense in people's lives, and from simplicity in *functionality and usability*, as well as in *look and feel*.

Take the electronic '**In Touch**' message board. It's an alternative to the 'message stuck to the fridge' or voice-mails left on answering machines – a common way of communicating in many busy family homes.

Doubling as a mirror, the In Touch board allows people to write or draw on it directly, or record videoclips and post them for other family members to see. People can send each other text, snapshots, even videos remotely, so they can keep in touch when away from home.

With something like this, when you are hurrying to the office in the morning, you might just place your finger on the image of a person's face then drag and drop it into the message you want to send to them.

Another Next Simplicity concept that uses wireless connectivity in a novel way is '**Momento**'. Momento is a glass ball that provides instant access to precious memories. As an object, it looks beautiful on a coffee table or bookcase. Then, when you want to store some of life's best moments – a child's first steps or winning the big match – you simply place a device such as a camera next to the ball and it stores the data. After that, it's just as simple to view the images. One touch plays the first clip, a shake moves on to the next one.

RFID pops up in Philips' Next Simplicity concepts in contexts you might never have dreamt of: the '**Herbarium**', >

Momento - view
your favorite images
with a simple touch





Herbarium - smart tags tell you the plant's name and even when it is time to harvest

a miniature solar-powered greenhouse, for instance. You simply place biodegradable pads – holding soil, seeds and an RFID tag – under an arch that provides light, heating and irrigation. The tag plays two roles. It communicates with LEDs on the pot to display the plant's name, so even the most inexperienced plant grower will know which plant is which. It also ensures each plant receives the light, water and nutrients it needs, and informs the owner when it's harvesting time.

Ambient Experience turns 'scary' into 'cool'

If this is the future, what of today? Our Ambient Experience confirms that RFID is being integrated into some surprising places. In this case, the world's first Ambient Experience pediatric radiology suite at Chicago's Lutheran General Hospital.

Hospitals are stressful for adults and can be positively scary for children. The Ambient Experience brings together an MRI or CT scanner, ambient lighting, dynamic projection, surround sound and RFID technology to turn scary into fun.

"Let's say a young boy is going for a CAT scan," says John Anastos, Chairman of Radiology at the Lutheran General Hospital. "First, he gets to preview various animation themes. He chooses his favorite and takes a holographic RFID badge with a Philips ICODE chip. When he goes into the examination room, he waves the badge at the scanning equipment, and the walls and ceiling come to life with animations, accompanied by music and other sounds.

It keeps him relaxed and it's a great way to give him instructions. When it's time for him to hold his breath, he sees a cartoon character holding his own breath!"

Clinical benefits

Everyone benefits, clinicians as well as patients. In a 'traditional' scanning situation, about one-third of children require sedation because they are unable to relax enough for a successful diagnostic exam. This can add six to eight hours of recovery time to a procedure that could be completed in 15 minutes.

"RFID is a prime example of how advanced technology improves people's lives."

'Positive distraction' keeps young patients calm so they're more likely to lie still. It also cuts down on the amount of radiation they're exposed to by avoiding the need for a re-scan.

RFID becomes part of life

"Innovative applications like Philips' Ambient Experience incorporate RFID and Near Field Communication (NFC) in new ways and in new areas," says Frans Scheper, Chief Marketing Officer, Philips Semiconductors.

"RFID is a prime example of how advanced technology improves people's lives. It may be hidden, part of a wider whole, but it is a fundamental enabler that makes a product, service or experience simpler and easier. In a sense, it typifies our approach at Semiconductors. We deliver simplicity – through the technologies we provide and through the ways we work with our customers and partners."

"Looking ahead to what's next for RFID, it's very clear: 'conventional' applications such as SCM and retail may lead the way, but the potential goes far beyond them."

For more information:

www.simplicity.philips.com/global_flash.html

www.philips.semiconductors.com/applications/smart_cards/index.html

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METRO Group brings the future to life today

How much can Radio Frequency Identification (RFID) deliver today? German retailer, the METRO Group, provides a pioneering example. Its RFID Innovation Center invites suppliers and partners to learn more about the business benefits, while shoppers in its Future Store can experience the advantages of a real-world 'supermarket of tomorrow'.

Zygmunt Mierdorf, METRO Group's Chief Information Officer, explains the company's innovative approach. "We recognized the potential of RFID early. Indeed, we were one of the first trading and retailing companies in the world to begin the gradual introduction of RFID along

our supply chain. But nowadays, no company can hope to establish a technology like this on its own, so we are delighted to have around 45 renowned partners who have joined us in pushing ahead with innovations in the trading and retailing sector."





Shoppers can experience these innovations in Metro's unique Future Store. A fully functional supermarket, the store allows Metro and its partners to try out new technologies in a live retail environment, identifying those that offer genuine advantages for retailers and consumers (see sidebar).

Closely involved since the start in 2002 / 2003, Philips is still helping develop concepts for the store. Today, as one of the most active members of the Metro RFID solution team, Philips provides vital RFID hardware and systems know-how as well as technology.

Currently, Metro uses Philips' UCODE EPC 1.19 ICs for pallet and box-level tagging. Given the success of these smart label products, Metro expects even better results once the ongoing transition to UCODE EPC Gen2 is complete. Moreover, Metro is testing the benefits of item-level tagging using the company's ICODE chips which offer important features for this application. ICODE-based labels are the only commercially-available HF tags to support a kill-command that permanently destroys the IC – an essential feature to reassure consumers that data on their purchases will not be kept against their wishes. Second, ICODE offers a reading speed of 200 tags per second, so inventories can be established quickly and 'smart gates' can handle a large throughput of tagged items.

Addressing supplier concerns

In contrast to the consumer-oriented Future Store, the RFID Innovation Center focuses on the needs of Metro's suppliers. Since November 2004, the company has been rolling out RFID throughout its supply chain, starting with pallets and moving on to carton-level tagging. Today this involves key suppliers, but ultimately medium and small suppliers will also be asked to adopt the technology.

"The aim is to help our suppliers – particularly medium and small-enterprises – to test RFID systems, such as readers and smart tags, with their own products and packaging units under real-life conditions," explains METRO Group's spokesman Albrecht von Truchsess.

Simulations show benefits of RFID

The RFID Innovation Center is open to any of the Group's partners. Its five simulation areas allow visitors

to see applications in action and understand why RFID deserves a place all the way through the supply chain from production to consumption.

The simulations start with **order picking**, one of the central tasks of any distribution center. "Visitors can discover how RFID leads to improved accuracy and efficiency," continues von Truchsess. "For instance, they can see how automatic sorters can handle up to 6,000 items per hour, and how they can use RFID to sort and mark items for shipment to the next link in the supply chain."

In **warehouse management**, there's an array of applications from RFID-enabled forklifts to handheld readers. For many visitors, however, a key point of interest is the use of EPCglobal technology. The EPC Network can pinpoint an item's location in the supply chain – downstream or upstream – from anywhere in the world, which makes it a very powerful business tool.

The METRO Group (like Philips) is actively involved in the development of EPCglobal standards because of the cost-effectiveness, visibility and interoperability the concept enables. Moreover, the two companies have been the driving force behind the EPCglobal Gen2, for which Philips now offers Gen2-compliant UCODE ICs (see Identification Updates on page 15).

The RFID Innovation Center is even an accredited EPCglobal performance test center, where partners can have their merchandise tagged with RFID transponders and tested. The lab is also developing solutions for technical problems such as tagging metals or liquids that interfere with the RFID signals.

Beyond supply chain management

Besides SCM, the simulations reveal RFID's potential to enhance the shopping experience and boost sales. In the **department store**, for example, a reader in the Smart Dressing Room recognizes items by their smart labels and provides further information. It can even encourage additional purchases by suggesting products and accessories that would work well with that item.

Meanwhile, in the **supermarket** section, visitors can discover many of the revolutionary technologies from the >

Future Store, such as displays, scales, smart shelves (to reduce out-of-stock situations), anti-theft and checkout systems.

Finally, there's a look to **RFID at home**, with a view of the future through Smart Fridges and Freezers that can automatically compile shopping lists (and one day even send them directly to the store via the appropriate infrastructure).

A vision made real through partnership

Metro's RFID Innovation Center is a space for training, guided tours, communication and education, as well as for testing solutions. Like the Future Store, it emphasizes the METRO Group's vision and belief in RFID, and its understanding that partnership and cooperation are key to its successful implementation.



Photo courtesy of METRO AG

Future Store: consumers experience tomorrow's supermarket

For the inhabitants of Rheinberg, Germany, a trip to the supermarket is a journey into the future. As they do their weekly shopping in Metro's Future Store, they find out what tomorrow's supermarket can do for them.

Forget about walking up and down looking for the right department. Shoppers here just ask the Personal Shopping Assistant (PSA) touchscreen on their shopping-cart. An interface to the store's entire systems, it can show where items are on a GPS-style map, or tell consumers about special offers of interest based on their shopping-list.

The PSA isn't the only screen in the store: big ones show advertisements; small ones answer customer questions. What wine goes with this fish? Where did this meat come from? Will this cereal trigger my peanut allergy? Then there's the 'Everywhere Display', that projects onto the floor and other surfaces. Just tell it what you want – and follow the arrows!

Every time a shopper puts something in the cart, the PSA adds the cost to the running total, so there are no surprises at the checkout – and no waiting either, because the point-of-sale (POS) device already knows how much to charge.

Good for business

The technologies that help the shoppers also help boost sales. Based on an IEEE 802.11b Wireless Local Area

Network (WLAN) that covers the entire store, everything's connected. So the smart shelves can read the smart labels and tell the merchandise management system (MMS) when it's time to restock a shelf or reorder a product.

The technology boosts business efficiency as well. Using PDAs, staff can order goods, check inventories, and send and receive emails and phonecalls over the WLAN from anywhere in the store.

Besides providing a great shopping experience, the Future Store educates consumers about RFID. It provides detailed information on the technology and demonstrates that no personal information is stored on the ICs. Plus, all goods equipped with smart labels are clearly marked with the EPC logo.

Finally, customers can simply deactivate every Philips ICODE-based label in their goods when they leave the store. It's a straightforward answer to worries about labels 'broadcasting' purchases to anyone with a scanner.

For more information:

www.semiconductors.philips.com/products/identification/icode/index.html

www.semiconductors.philips.com/products/identification/ucode/index.html

NFC in everything

In Mainz, Germany, **Arygon Technologies** foresees a future of intuitive connectivity, with NFC everywhere. What's more, it's actively turning that dream into a reality, launching the world's first commercially available NFC/MIFARE reader modules. CEO Dr. Ulrich Tetzner explains.



Dr. Ulrich Tetzner

"What customers want is an easy transition," says Ulrich. "And that's what they get when they buy one of our NFC/MIFARE products: a single solution that lets them keep on using MIFARE, then bring the NFC functionality into play when it suits them."

Three solutions

Before NFC, Arygon was already using Philips' MIFARE ICs in its reader solutions – and today, its three NFC/MIFARE solutions are all based on Philips NFC reader ICs. All three enable contactless peer-to-peer connectivity in a wide range of applications, such as ticketing, point-of-sale, access control, payment or virtual connector.



Launched in July 2005, the multi-functional ACMA core module was Arygon's first NFC/MIFARE product – and the world's first non-proprietary reader module to support NFC. "Quite simply, it enables NFC in anything: cellphones, PDAs, measurement systems, robots, manufacturing equipment, logistics monitoring systems... and thanks to its open architecture, it's easy to integrate. We tailor it to meet our customers' requirements, offering various

interfaces, levels of intelligence – and prices. Target customers are high-end system integrators, who'll build it into their existing reader solutions."

"Our Plug 'n' Play APPA module is based on the ACMA, but it's ready to 'drop' into a design. So it's popular with customers who don't want to do a lot of development work or learn all about NFC. With their existing products, they can simply take out the MIFARE module and replace it with the APPA module."

"Our latest product is the AMPA, a cellphone solution which we developed in just four weeks, largely thanks to Philips, who provided fantastic support – everything from the ICs to the documentation we needed. So it was ready for Cartes 2005, where we demonstrated it in a customer's 'PayPhone'."

Niche markets lead the way

Arygon is targeting smaller companies who can react quickly and open up the really innovative markets. "We're already supplying MIFARE/MIFARE DESFire cards to several German football clubs. They're very interested in our NFC/MIFARE modules, which can read MIFARE season tickets and NFC devices – the ones we'll all be using in the not-too-distant future for everything from access and payment to loyalty schemes and OTA (over-the-air) downloads."

"Looking further ahead, there's no limit to the potential of NFC's intuitive connectivity. PCs, cars, washing-machines – all it takes is the right customer with the right idea. When they come to us, we'll be ready with the right solution."

For more information:

www.semiconductors.philips.com/markets/identification/products/mifare/index.html

www.semiconductors.philips.com

“In the security market, I see significant growth ahead in biometrics and contactless smart cards.”

Partner perspective

In our Partner perspective, we talk to Jan-Peter Hulsker, CEO of **Integrated Engineering**. Headquartered in the Dutch capital of Amsterdam, Integrated Engineering is the market leader in the smart passport industry – and one of Philips' partners in smart passport solutions.



Jan-Peter Hulsker

Integrated Engineering

Integrated Engineering started as an equipment manufacturer in 1980, and now supplies solutions to the identification market. Until recently it focused on the security market, offering solutions for access control readers, ranging from basic readers up to advanced biometric readers using iris-based identification. Today, the focus has shifted firmly to electronic identification – in particular, smart passports.

“Our company’s main product is our hardware platform, based on Philips’ contactless reader ICs,” says Jan-Peter. “We sell this to OEM manufacturers who make readers for the security, ePayment and e-Identification markets. It’s a single platform that works with any technology from any manufacturer – you just need the right firmware and it’ll work with any operating system. That’s one of our biggest advantages.”

“It’s also one of the reasons we like working with Philips. We use a patented process to program and update the readers in the field. Philips’ SmartMX ICs offer the memory to store the necessary firmware, and the encryption to keep it safe. It’s the most reliable chip in the field and incredibly fast for a secure contactless IC.”

Shared vision

When Jan-Peter joined the company in 1998, the focus was on access control applications. MIFARE had just hit the market, and Jan-Peter already knew that the future was contactless. After he’d taken a careful look at the various companies on the market, he also realized that Integrated Engineering’s future lay with Philips. “We selected Philips as our sole supplier for MIFARE ICs,” he says. “It wasn’t purely because we were impressed by their product. You don’t start a relationship like that without understanding a potential partner’s development plans and vision of the future. You need a partner who understands the whole value chain. Philips has a history of commitment to open standards, and to the industry-wide cooperation that’s needed to put them into action.”

Of the many reader suppliers targeting the ePassport market, only three receive dedicated support from Philips. Integrated Engineering – the market leader – is one of them. “A reliable reader infrastructure is key to Philips’ own success here,” says Jan-Peter, “and they’ve seen that our solution works perfectly with their smart card chips. They trust our expertise, and they know we’re ‘close to the fire’, as we’ve been working on ePassports for three years, and participating in the ICAO and ISO discussions. In fact, when

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Philips' vendors show customers an ePassport solution based on Smart/MX or ProX chips, they take one of our demo suitcases with them."

A booming market

Integrated Engineering's reader platform uses Philips' RC531 (for ISO 14443) or RC632 (for ISO 14443 and ISO 15693) chips. "We sold over 50,000 last year – a huge number for a reader market – and we're expecting a real boom, starting next year. It's largely thanks to the US' deadline: as of October 25th 2006, citizens of Visa Waiver Program countries will need a biometric passport to get into the US without a Visa."

And the reader infrastructure isn't limited to the verification equipment at border controls, banks and other places where people need to identify themselves. "That's the biggest market, but don't forget the passport production machines and the enrolment devices that collect the data – in the Netherlands alone, we're supplying the platform for 3000 of these enrolment devices. And finally, you have the personalization stations where the data is actually written to the chip."

The next three years will be critical for the reader market, as governments deploy the infrastructure. But even after that, they'll still need to replace and upgrade their equipment. And of course, volumes will be much higher for the ICs that go in the passports themselves.

What's more, the launch of the ePassport will have a knock-on effect on other markets. "In the security market, I see significant growth ahead in biometrics and

contactless smart cards. Once people see the security benefits of contactless, biometric ePassports, they'll be happy to use these technologies in other applications. As Smart/MX proves, contactless smart cards are the ideal way to implement biometrics in high-security applications. As each smart passport carries its owner's credentials, a reader doesn't have to access a central database with millions of identities, speeding border checks as well as keeping the data safely stored on the passport.

Partnership for interoperability

On top of speed and security, the final 'piece in the puzzle' is interoperability: "To qualify for the new ISO/IEC7501 ePassport standard (based on the ICAO's specifications in document 9303), every reader must work with every card and vice versa. Sometimes we need some extra help here, and Philips has been great at providing all the support we need."

"Looking to the future, we will keep working together where the growth is. There are a number of upcoming technologies – like Near Field Communication – which we know will be important to us. We've had offers from different silicon manufacturers (and we do work with them occasionally) but our core components remain Philips. We're happy with the partnership. Philips is happy with it. There's no reason to change direction."

For more information:

www.semiconductors.philips.com/applications/smart_card/banking/banking/index.html#smx
www.semiconductors.philips.com/markets/identification/products/mifare/index.html



NFC in Caen – just wave your phone...

Interest in Near Field Communication (NFC) is really beginning to take off – see the 'NFC in everything' and 'Partner Perspective' articles in this issue. In On The Move 7.3 we also reported on Dutch football club Roda JC and the ongoing cellphone-based NFC trial at its 'Parkstad Limburg' stadium. We now take a look at the French city of Caen, which saw the launch of the world's first large-scale trial of NFC on 18 October.

Thanks to Samsung's NFC-enabled D500 phones, 200 of Caen's residents are enjoying easy access to a range of services. The Philips smart card chip in each phone lets them make payments and use banking applications, supported by one of the highest levels of security on the market. At the same time, the phone's NFC chip – also from Philips – is providing the unparalleled simplicity of this touch-based technology.

Simplifying transactions, reducing the time spent in queues, providing easily-accessible information – NFC offers a broad range of benefits. In this six-month trial, the phones' solution is enabling secure, over-the-air (OTA) download of applications on a GSM network. It even knows which application to launch when a connection is made.

Philips is working with France Telecom, Orange, Samsung, Groupe LaSer and Vinci Park to offer participants a range of applications. Demonstrating how much NFC can improve our everyday lives, the trial is also helping fine-tune the technologies and business models involved.

From stores to tours

At the Monoprix supermarkets, Galeries Lafayette and other stores in the Groupe LaSer chain, participants pay for their purchases with a simple swipe of the phone. In car parks, the NFC application cuts down on the queues twice, issuing virtual tickets on the way in and debiting the cost on the way out.

But the trial covers more than payment applications. At some of Caen's landmarks, participants can swipe their phones across 'information points' to access tourist information in the form of an SMS or a phonecall. And as the trial progresses, additional applications are being added. Like the 'smart posters' that use NFC to sell mobile phone content such as ringtones and wallpaper.

For more information:

www.semiconductors.philips.com

www.semiconductors.philips.com/news/infocus/nfc_trial_caen/

Identification updates

UCODE achieves EPCGlobal Gen2 certification

Philips is the first major silicon supplier to bring an EPC Gen2 certified RFID chip to market with its UCODE EPC Generation 2 ICs. Closely involved in all aspects of the EPCglobal standard development process, we were ready to go into full volume production as soon as our UCODE SL3 ICS1001 received certification.

EPCglobal Inc finalized the G2 specification, the first royalty-free, global RFID standard that meets all major regional requirements at the end of 2004. Made up of over 60 leading global players, the not-for-profit EPCglobal organization is driving global adoption of Ultra High Frequency (UHF) Electronic Product Code (EPC) technology.

Retailers such as the METRO Group have already committed to implementing G2 RFID technology in their supply chain management systems (see page 8). "Philips' UCODE EPC G2 compliance will enable the METRO Group to enlarge our existing RFID rollout," said Dr. Gerd Wolfram, Managing Director of MGI METRO Group Information Technology GmbH. "Retailers and suppliers want – and need – a single, globally-accepted standard that will deliver cost-effectiveness and full

interoperability which is supported by large technology providers such as Philips."

EPCglobal G2 will ensure interoperability between readers and labels from different suppliers, as well as offer performance, cost and reliability improvements, with an easy migration to future EPC classes.

The Philips SL3 ICS1001

- Supports both EPCglobal and ISO 18000-6C coding structures.
- Runs on the same hardware infrastructure as UCODE EPC1.19 and UCODE HSL ICs, simplifying the move to EPCglobal Class G2.
- Enables 1,600 labels to be read per second under US regulations; up to 600 labels per second under European regulations
- Offers a read range of up to 7 m in the US; 6.6 m in Europe
- Features a one-time programmable memory for the 96-bit EPC

www.semiconductors.philips.com/news/content/file_1201.html

New Information Forum to assist RFID's uptake

Opening its doors on January 19, 2006, the Informationsforum RFID e.V. will play an important part in RFID's growth. The Forum was founded by major players from the retail, consumer goods, IT and services sectors. With over a billion RFID chips sold and extensive RFID know-how in many existing and emerging markets, Philips is an active participant.

Located in Berlin, Germany, the Forum will promote acceptance of RFID and create awareness of its potential by providing information on technology and applications. It will also provide a discussion platform, where consumers and representatives from politics, business, academia and the media can examine key issues. For more information: www.info-rfid.de

Meet us at the following events

Event: **CES**

Date: 5 - 8 January, 2006

Location: Las Vegas, USA

Website: www.semiconductors.philips.com/news/infocus/ces2006/

Event: **3GSM World Congress**

Date: 13 - 16 February, 2006

Location: Barcelona, Spain

Website: www.3gsmworldcongress.com

Event: **RFID Connect Singapore**

Date: 14 - 17 February, 2006

Location: Singapore

Website: www.availcorp.com/english

Event: **RFID World**

Date: 27 February - 1 March, 2006

Location: Dallas, USA

Website: <http://rfid-world.com/rfid06>

Event: **CTIA Wireless 2006**

Date: 5 - 7 April, 2006

Location: Las Vegas, USA

Website: www.ctiawireless.com

Event: **RFID World Asia**

Date: 26 - 28 April, 2006

Location: Singapore

Website: www.worldofcards.biz/2006/rfidwa_sg

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